ROYALTY FREE

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction and word list. Choose 3 words, brainstorm, begin composing.	Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the five steps, four words to know, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet, the Word list and the Creative brief. Check that each student has 3 words before they leave.	Slides 1–7	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Classes 2–4:** Working days — compose and refine your 1-minute piece.	Slides 8–9: words become sound, and your 3 words are your brief. Hand out the Listening log. Then work time.	Slides 8–9	p. 15
CLASS 3		Slides 10–12: step 3, build-peak-resolve and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Arrangement plan and the Layers and mix sheet. Then work time.	Slides 10–12	p. 16, p. 17
CLASS 4		Slide 13: one minute goes fast. Then work time. Ask each student to play their first 20 seconds and say which word they hear.	Slide 13	—
CLASS 5	**Class 5:** Mix and finalize. Write reflection paragraph.	Slides 14–15: step 4, mix, and steps 5 and 6, the reflection paragraph and the bounce. Students plan their paragraph on the Reflection page (page 24).	Slides 14–15	p. 24
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–17: what to turn in and the rubric. Students bounce, name their files and post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–17	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions.	Slides 18–19	p. 23

THE ONE THING TO DO ON CLASS 1

Ask each student to name where their music could be used (my first tip) and to write three words on the Creative brief before they leave. If a word is only what they like, ask: how would you play that word to someone who had never heard it?

CLASSES 2–4

Working days; Class 4 has one slide. Circulate with one question: which of your three words is this layer for?

PREVIEW

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Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Open Doors", described on paper**, for a one-minute tour of a renovated school library (an invented video): no audio is included. Students' projects will differ. 30 bars at 120 BPM, three words, four sections, seven layers (page 1 of 2).

1 · A WEAK PLAN

I will make a happy song with a nice beat.

It names no words and nothing says why any choice was made.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

My video is a one-minute tour of a renovated school library (an invented video). My three words are Bright, Steady and Uplifting. Bright: bells and plucked keys in a major key, with the highs lifted a little. Steady: 120 BPM that never changes, a kick on every beat and one chord for every two bars. Uplifting: a bell melody that climbs, a new layer every few bars, and an ending that lands on the home chord. It is 30 bars, 60 seconds, in four sections: intro, build, peak and resolve. Two layers are Apple Loops that I cut and rearrange.

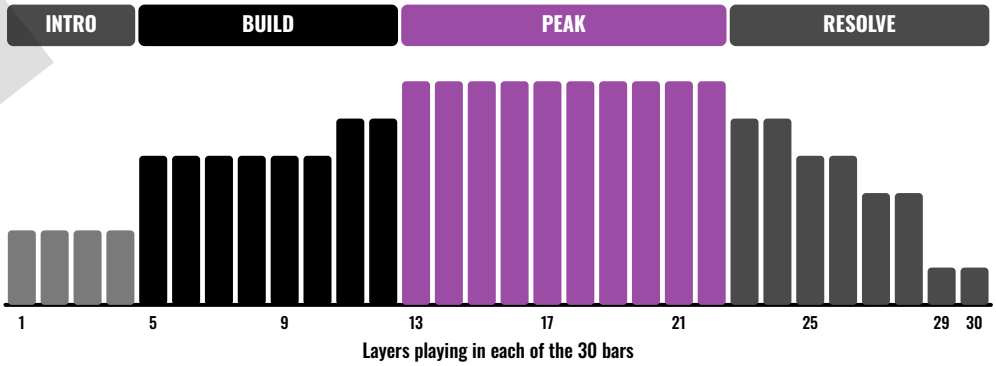
3 · THREE WORDS, FOUR KINDS OF CHOICE ·

	BRIGHT	STEADY	UPLIFTING
SOUNDS	bells · plucked keys	soft pad · bass	bell melody climbs
RHYTHM	light, clear hits	kick on every beat	drums enter in the Build
HARMONY	major key (C)	one chord per 2 bars	ends on home chord C
MIX	highs lifted	nothing jumps out	opens up in the Peak

Every choice connects back to a word

WORD	SOUNDS	RHYTHM	HARMONY	MIX
Bright	bells · plucked keys	light, clear hits	major key (C)	highs lifted
Steady	soft pad · bass	kick on every beat	one chord per 2 bars	nothing jumps out
Uplifting	bell melody climbs	drums enter in the Build	ends on home chord C	opens up in the Peak

4 · BUILD, PEAK, RESOLVE: LAYERS IN EACH BAR ·



Layers playing in each of the 30 bars

PREVIEW

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Word list

STUDENT

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 1: review the word list and pick 3 that define your track's mood. Requirement 2: choose 3 descriptive words from the provided list. Descriptive words are adjectives that define the mood and character of a piece (e.g., "upbeat," "cinematic"). Circle three, then copy them onto your Creative brief. The words are listed A to Z.

- Acoustic
- Adventure
- Alternative
- Ambient
- Ballad
- Baroque
- Beautiful
- Biphonic
- Bittersweet
- Bluegrass
- Blues
- Bluesy
- Breathtaking
- Breathy
- Bright
- Calming
- Catchy
- Ceremonial
- Choral
- Classic
- Classical
- Complex
- Computerised
- Contemporary
- Country
- Cultural
- Dainty
- Depressing
- Diminishing
- Distinct
- Drab
- Dramatic
- Dynamic
- Eclectic
- Electric
- Electronic
- Emotional
- Empowering
- Enchanting
- Energetic
- Enigmatic
- Enthusiastic
- Epic
- Ethereal
- Exciting
- Exhilarating
- Expressive
- Extravagant
- Faint
- Feel-good
- Flat
- Fluid
- Folk
- Fortissimo
- Frantic
- Fresh
- Funky
- Gentle
- Glorious
- Gradual
- Grandiose
- Groovy
- Groundbreaking
- Happy
- Hardcore
- Harmonic
- Harmonious
- Harmonised
- Haunting
- Healing
- Heartfelt
- Heterophonic
- Hip-Hop
- Hypnotic
- Inciting
- Indie
- Indulgent
- Inspirational
- Inspiring
- Instrumental
- Intense
- Invigorating
- Jazz
- Jazzy
- Joyful
- Latin
- Life-changing
- Light
- Loud
- Lyrical
- Magical
- Majestic
- Melancholic
- Melancholy
- Mellow
- Melodic
- Melodious
- Mesmerising
- Mesmerizing
- Monophonic
- Moody
- Motivating
- Motivational
- Musical
- Mythical
- Natural
- New Age
- Nostalgic
- Opera
- Orchestral
- Passionate
- Poetic
- Poignant
- Polyphonic
- Pop
- Powerful
- Progressive Rock
- Radical
- Rap
- Refined
- Rejuvenating
- Relaxing
- Restoring
- Rhythmic
- Rich
- Riveting
- Romantic
- Sad
- Saturated
- Sentimental
- Shrill
- Simple
- Slow
- Smooth
- Soaring
- Soft
- Sombre
- Sonic
- Soothing
- Sophisticated
- Soulful
- Staccato
- Steady
- Stratospheric
- Stylized
- Sublime
- Symphonic
- Synthetic
- Talented
- Tempo
- Thrilling
- Tranquil
- Transcendent
- Upbeat
- Uplifting
- Vibrant
- Visionary
- Vocal
- Warm
- Wonderous

MY THREE WORDS

Word 1: _____ **Word 2:** _____ **Word 3:** _____

Why they go together: _____

PREVIEW

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ROYALTY FREE

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Royalty Free | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

PREVIEW

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